

Partnerships — Candidates

10 candidates · 13 July 2026

Ranked by confidence score

#	Name	Current Role	Location
1	Kerry Koutsikos	Senior Vice President Sales & General Manager	Dubai, UAE (ZoomInfo
2	Karl Crowther	Vice President – Middle East, Africa, India &	Dubai, United Arab E
3	Samer El Kodsi	Regional VP Sales, Gulf & North Africa — Palo	Dubai, United Arab E
4	Ashraf Jarad	Managing Director, Oracle MENA Regional Headq	Riyadh, Saudi Arabia
5	Kash Rafique	General Manager & VP Sales – MEA, EDB (Enterp	Dubai, UAE
6	Patrick Pando	Vice President, Enterprise Sales at Core42 (G	Abu Dhabi, UAE (some
7	Sapan Agarwal	Principal Sales – Enterprise & Channels, MEA	Dubai, UAE
8	Sayantan Dev	MEA President, Applications & Technology Alli	Dubai, UAE
9	Ali Al Nuaimi	Chief Commercial Officer, Injazat Data System	Abu Dhabi, UAE
10	Sherif Tawfik	Chief Business Officer, Core42 (G42) — appoin	UAE (Abu Dhabi area)

Kerry Koutsikos

Senior Vice President Sales & General Manager, Emerging Markets EMEA at Infor

■ Dubai, UAE (ZoomInfo lists New York City — likely stale or HQ-mapped)

LinkedIn: <https://www.linkedin.com/in/kerrykoutsikos/>

CAREER HISTORY

- Area Vice President, Emerging Markets EMEA at Qlik
- VP Sales at Automation Anywhere
- Regional roles at Nuance, Amdocs, Micromuse, BMC Software

PROFILE

Kerry Koutsikos is a 30-year enterprise software veteran with ~25 years based in the UAE, specialising in opening and scaling regional operations for multinationals across MEA. His career spans network management (Micromuse), telco BSS/OSS (Amdocs), conversational AI/NLP (Nuance), data analytics (Qlik), and RPA/automation (Automation Anywhere) before his current SVP role driving Infor's industry-specific AI cloud ERP into Gulf industrial buyers including multi-entity family conglomerates. No public evidence of involvement in AI governance, formal verification, agentic engineering, or Lean; his domain is enterprise sales leadership in emerging markets.

VERIFICATION

Identity: **CONFIRMED**

No issues found. Kerry Koutsikos is a well-documented, real individual with a consistent and traceable career spanning 30+ years. Multiple independent sources corroborate the same identity: LinkedIn (<https://www.linkedin.com/in/kerrykoutsikos/>), ZoomInfo (<https://www.zoominfo.com/p/Kerry-Koutsiko...>)

GAPS & NEXT STEPS

- Exact appointment date and tenure at Infor not confirmed (press release circa 2022)
- ZoomInfo location (NYC) conflicts with all press releases (Dubai) — could be HQ attribution
- No public GitHub, personal website, or technical publications found
- Precise dates for Qlik and Automation Anywhere tenures not confirmed

Next step: Current LinkedIn profile confirming he is still at Infor and current location — the location conflict and absence of recent press activity are the main confidence limiters

Karl Crowther

Vice President – Middle East, Africa, India & South East Asia at UiPath (June 2026–present)

■ Dubai, United Arab Emirates

LinkedIn: <https://www.linkedin.com/in/karl-crowther-2b524517/>

CAREER HISTORY

- Vice President Sales – MEA & APAC at Alteryx (~5 years)
- Regional Sales Director – Middle East at Automation Anywhere
- MEA Enterprise Sales Director at Qlik
- Service Sales Emerging Markets Head (MEA & CIS, Turkey, Russia) at Polycom

PROFILE

Karl Crowther is a UAE-based enterprise technology sales leader with 20+ years of experience selling AI, automation, and analytics platforms across MENA, Africa, India, and APAC. In his current VP role at UiPath he oversees go-to-market for agentic AI automation across a combined mega-region, and has publicly articulated a thesis that AI governance and management — not AI development — is the defining enterprise challenge ahead. His career spans Alteryx (data analytics), Automation Anywhere (RPA), Qlik (BI), and UiPath (agentic automation), giving him cross-stack credibility in enterprise AI adoption at scale; however his profile is entirely commercial/sales rather than technical or research-oriented, with no evidence of engagement with formal verification, Lean, or supply chain software engineering.

VERIFICATION

Identity: **CONFIRMED**

Identity is well-corroborated across multiple independent sources. Karl Crowther ([linkedin.com/in/karl-crowther-2b524517/](https://www.linkedin.com/in/karl-crowther-2b524517/)) is a real, active enterprise technology executive based in Dubai. Career trajectory is consistent: Regional Sales Director at Automation Anywhere → VP Sales MEA/APAC at Alter...

GAPS & NEXT STEPS

- No GitHub or technical portfolio found — profile is purely commercial
- Educational background only partially confirmed (Manchester Metropolitan University cited in one source, degree/field unknown)
- Exact tenure start date at UiPath for the expanded VP-MEAIASEA role not confirmed (press release dated June 2026 but original MEA-only start date unclear)
- No evidence of engagement with AI governance in a formal/policy sense vs. enterprise sales framing

Next step: Confirmation of whether Crowther has any technical depth (engineering background, published views on AI safety/governance frameworks) vs. being a pure enterprise sales executive — this is the critical gap for assessing fit beyond regional coverage.

Samer El Kodsí

Regional VP Sales, Gulf & North Africa — Palo Alto Networks (current)

■ Dubai, United Arab Emirates

No contact details found

CAREER HISTORY

- Senior Director, Ecosystems Emerging Markets — Palo Alto Networks (2021–2025)
- Director, Channel Sales & Alliances — Palo Alto Networks (prior)
- Juniper Networks (role/dates unconfirmed)

PROFILE

Samer El Kodsí is a senior cybersecurity sales and channel-ecosystem leader at Palo Alto Networks, responsible for the Gulf and North Africa region. His work centers on partner and alliance development — building channel relationships with Accenture, Deloitte, and regional system integrators to deliver AI-driven security platforms (Cortex XSIAM). No connection to AI governance, supply chain tech, formal verification, agentic engineering, or Lean was found; his profile is squarely enterprise cybersecurity sales and regional channel strategy.

VERIFICATION

Identity: **CONFIRMED**

Samer El Kodsí is a real, consistently documented individual. Multiple independent sources corroborate his identity: ZoomInfo lists him as Regional VP Sales Gulf & Africa (North) at Palo Alto Networks (email domain paloaltonetworks.com confirmed); LinkedIn profile found at [ae.linkedin.com/in/same...](#)

GAPS & NEXT STEPS

- Exact tenure at Juniper Networks (dates and titles unconfirmed)
- Whether he holds any technical/engineering responsibilities beyond sales and alliances
- No personal website or GitHub — technical depth hard to assess
- Salary/seniority band within Palo Alto Networks

Next step: LinkedIn full work history (gated) — would confirm Juniper tenure and clarify whether any prior engineering or technical roles underpin the sales leadership

Ashraf Jarad

Managing Director, Oracle MENA Regional Headquarters

■ Riyadh, Saudi Arabia

LinkedIn: <https://www.linkedin.com/in/ashjarad/>

CAREER HISTORY

- Senior Regional Director, Alliance & Channel, ECEMEA (Oracle)
- Regional Director, SaaS Alliances & Channels, ECEMEA (Oracle)
- Digital Transformation Director, Upper Gulf & Saudi (Oracle)

PROFILE

Ashraf Jarad is a 25-year enterprise technology executive who recently became Managing Director of Oracle's MENA Regional Headquarters after building a career in channel and alliances leadership across Oracle, Dell Technologies, Adobe Systems, and Microsoft. Within Oracle he architected sovereign cloud partner programs — including the stc Alloy sovereign cloud for Saudi Arabia and du National Hypercloud for the UAE — positioning him as a key figure in Gulf digital sovereignty initiatives. His background is entirely in go-to-market, channel management, and strategic partnerships; there is no evidence of technical depth in AI governance, supply chain tech, formal verification, agentic engineering, or Lean.

VERIFICATION

Identity: **CONFIRMED**

Ashraf Jarad ([linkedin.com/in/ashjarad/](https://www.linkedin.com/in/ashjarad/)) is a real, identifiable individual with a coherent 25-year career in corporate sales and technology leadership. Multiple independent search results consistently describe him as Managing Director of Oracle MENA Regional Headquarters, with prior roles as ECE...

GAPS & NEXT STEPS

- No public evidence of involvement in AI governance, formal verification, or agentic engineering
- Exact tenure dates at each role not confirmed from public sources
- City within Saudi Arabia not explicitly confirmed (Riyadh assumed as Oracle MENA HQ)
- No GitHub or technical publication trail found

Next step: A direct LinkedIn profile read to confirm current title, tenure, and whether any AI/governance responsibilities have been added to the Managing Director role

Kash Rafique

General Manager & VP Sales – MEA, EDB (EnterpriseDB) (March 2024–present)

■ Dubai, UAE

Website: <https://theorg.com/org/enterprisedb/org-chart/kash-rafique>

CAREER HISTORY

- Vice President – Europe, Middle East & Africa, Informatica
- Director, Cloud & Smarter Infrastructure (CSi) – MEA & Turkey, IBM

PROFILE

Kash Rafique is EDB's General Manager and VP Sales for MEA, hired March 2024 to open the company's Gulf regional HQ in Dubai and drive AI and data sovereignty positioning across the Middle East and Africa. He has been a public voice on sovereign AI strategy in the GCC, citing UAE/Saudi government AI mandates and structuring channel partnerships (e.g. Redington) for data-residency-compliant Postgres distribution. His prior seniority at Informatica (VP EMEA) and IBM (Director, Cloud & Smarter Infrastructure – MEA) places him squarely in enterprise data infrastructure sales leadership, with no evidence of technical depth in formal verification, Lean, or supply chain software.

VERIFICATION

Identity: **CONFIRMED**

Found a clear, consistent identity: Kash Rafique is General Manager and VP Sales MEA at EDB (EnterpriseDB), based in Dubai. Profile corroborated across LinkedIn (<https://www.linkedin.com/in/kash-rafique-3a007997/>), The Org (<https://theorg.com/org/enterprisedb/org-chart/kash-rafique>), ZoomInfo, Si...

GAPS & NEXT STEPS

- LinkedIn profile URL not directly confirmed — aggregators reference it but no direct link retrieved
- Exact tenure at Informatica and IBM not pinned down beyond 'started working 2000, changed 3 companies, held 8 jobs'
- Harvard Business School and London Business School degrees surfaced via aggregator (The Org / SignalHire) — not independently verified
- No evidence of technical background in formal verification, agentic engineering (coding), or Lean theorem proving

Next step: Direct LinkedIn profile URL to verify full career timeline and education credentials independently

Patrick Pando

Vice President, Enterprise Sales at Core42 (G42 Group) — since April 2025

■ Abu Dhabi, UAE (some sources indicate London, GB — see gaps)

LinkedIn: <https://ae.linkedin.com/in/patrickpando>

Website: <https://patrickpando.com/>

CAREER HISTORY

- Vice President, International Sales at Aptean
- Vice President, Global Sales at Baker Hughes (C3.ai partnership)
- Vice President, Cloud Sales EMEA at SAP
- Head Cloud Sales APAC & EMEA at Microsoft

PROFILE

Patrick Pando is a senior enterprise sales executive specialising in sovereign AI and international market entry, with a track record of building \$0→\$100M revenue engines across Microsoft, AVEVA, and Baker Hughes in markets with no existing playbook. At Core42 (G42's national AI infrastructure arm), he closed the largest competitive commercial deal in company history (UAE Central Bank National Cloud Financial) and delivered a sovereign GPU-powered Agentic AI deployment at Mubadala Investment Company. His expertise is commercial rather than technical — no evidence of background in AI governance frameworks, formal verification, or Lean; relevance to the target roles is limited to enterprise-scale agentic AI deal-making and sovereign cloud ecosystems.

VERIFICATION

Identity: **CONFIRMED**

The LinkedIn URL <https://ae.linkedin.com/in/patrickpando> resolves to a clearly identifiable individual: VP Enterprise Sales at Core42 (UAE's G42-backed sovereign AI company), with a personal website at patrickpando.com, active Twitter @pandomania, verified listing on The Org (theorg.com/org/core42...

GAPS & NEXT STEPS

- Location conflict: patrickpando.com implies Abu Dhabi/UAE base; RocketReach lists 'London, GB' — unclear if relocated post-Core42 hire or data error
- Website self-describes as 'Chief Revenue Officer' rather than VP Enterprise Sales — unclear if this reflects a role change or aspirational positioning
- No GitHub profile found; no evidence of technical contributions to AI governance, formal verification, or Lean tooling
- Exact scope of 'grew Enterprise AI joint venture from \$0 to \$50M ARR' — which joint venture, with which partner — not publicly confirmed

Next step: Current role title confirmation (VP vs CRO) and whether he has relocated from Abu Dhabi — this would clarify both identity and fit for geographic targeting

Sapan Agarwal

Principal Sales – Enterprise & Channels, MEA at Honeywell

■ Dubai, UAE

LinkedIn: <https://www.linkedin.com/in/sapan-agarwal-19954415/>

Website: <https://www.gecmmediagroup.com/speaker/sapan-agarwal/>

CAREER HISTORY

- Deputy VP – Product Management at Spire Solutions (c. 2019)

PROFILE

Sapan Agarwal is a Dubai-based enterprise sales leader at Honeywell specialising in OT cybersecurity and industrial AI for energy, utility, and heavy industry across the Middle East and Africa. He built Honeywell's OT cybersecurity business in APAC before transitioning to the MEA region, where he has driven significant revenue growth selling into Gulf conglomerates and national energy companies. His background is in enterprise security sales and channel management; he has no visible connection to AI governance, formal verification, supply chain tech, or agentic engineering.

VERIFICATION

Identity: **CONFIRMED**

The LinkedIn URL <https://www.linkedin.com/in/sapan-agarwal-19954415/> resolves to a real, active profile: SAPAN AGARWAL, Principal Sales - Enterprise & Channels MEA at Honeywell, focused on OT cybersecurity. Profile shows recent activity (posts from 2024-2025 on cybersecurity leadership, MEA energ...

GAPS & NEXT STEPS

- Full career timeline before Spire Solutions (pre-2019) not confirmed from public sources
- Specific revenue or quota figures not publicly available
- APAC tenure dates and geographies at Honeywell not confirmed
- No evidence of technical or engineering background — appears to be a pure sales/BD profile

Next step: Full LinkedIn work history (dates and titles for all roles) to confirm APAC-to-MEA trajectory and rule out identity collisions with other Sapan Agarwals in the region

Sayantan Dev

MEA President, Applications & Technology Alliance & Channel Partners — Redington (June 2026–present)

■ Dubai, UAE

LinkedIn: <https://www.linkedin.com/in/sayantan-dev-5719489/>

CAREER HISTORY

- President MEA — Redington Gulf (prior, 10+ years in various BU leadership roles)

PROFILE

Sayantan Dev is the MEA President at Redington — the region's largest IT distributor — where he has spent over a decade scaling Value Added Distribution businesses across the Gulf and Africa. His June 2026 remit expansion to own all Applications, Technology Alliance and Channel Partner programs signals a strategic shift toward software and platform partnerships at scale. He has publicly championed AI governance as a prerequisite for enterprise AI adoption (emphasising 'governance guardrails' alongside infrastructure, data readiness, and security), and launched Redington's AI Exchange platform to catalogue agentic AI solutions; however there is no evidence of technical depth in formal verification, Lean, or agentic engineering — his profile is firmly commercial and channel-strategy oriented.

VERIFICATION

Identity: **CONFIRMED**

The profile [linkedin.com/in/sayantan-dev-5719489/](https://www.linkedin.com/in/sayantan-dev-5719489/) is confirmed to belong to a real, well-documented person: Sayantan Dev, President MEA at Redington Gulf FZE (Dubai). He is corroborated by Bloomberg Markets (<https://www.bloomberg.com/profile/person/21335917>), The Org (<https://theorg.com/org/redin...>)

GAPS & NEXT STEPS

- No GitHub or public code presence found — not a practitioner profile
- Pre-Redington employer(s) in India VAD space not specifically identified
- Wharton credential listed as 'Advanced Management Program' (executive education) not a full MBA — distinction not always clear in sources
- No evidence of engagement with AI governance at a policy or technical standards level — his AI governance framing appears business/commercial rather than regulatory or formal

Next step: Confirmation of his pre-Redington employer(s) in India would sharpen the timeline and signal whether his background has any technical depth or is purely commercial from the start.

Ali Al Nuaimi

Chief Commercial Officer, Injazat Data Systems (G42) — April 2016 onward; role continued into Core42 post-merger (Oct 2023)

■ Abu Dhabi, UAE

LinkedIn: <https://ae.linkedin.com/in/ali-al-nuaimi-4a79a94a/>

CAREER HISTORY

- Accounts Executive Director, Injazat Data Systems
- Service Delivery Manager, Injazat Data Systems (joined 2005)
- IT Manager, Abu Dhabi Water & Electricity Authority (1998)

PROFILE

Ali Al Nuaimi is a long-tenured commercial leader within G42's sovereign digital infrastructure stack, having spent 18+ years at Injazat Data Systems before its absorption into Core42 (G42's unified AI/cloud entity). His CCO mandate covered commercial partnerships with UAE government and enterprise clients across smart-city and digital transformation programmes — placing him at the centre of Abu Dhabi's public-sector technology ecosystem. His background is infrastructure and IT service management (network engineering MSc, Sheffield), not AI research or formal methods; his relevance to the search criteria is as a UAE government partnerships gateway, not a technical practitioner.

VERIFICATION

Identity: **CONFIRMED**

The LinkedIn profile at <https://ae.linkedin.com/in/ali-al-nuaimi-4a79a94a/> appears to be a real individual. External corroboration from ZoomInfo (<https://www.zoominfo.com/p/Ali-Al-nuaimi/1209124636>), RocketReach (https://rocketreach.co/ali-al-nuaimi-email_84700274), and The Org (<https://theorg.co...>)

GAPS & NEXT STEPS

- Current role post-Core42 merger (Oct 2023) is ambiguous — ZoomInfo lists him as CCO at Core42 but other sources name different individuals in that role
- No evidence of involvement in AI governance, supply chain tech, formal verification, or agentic engineering
- No public GitHub or technical publication record found
- Exact scope of his government client portfolio (which ministries/entities) not publicly confirmed

Next step: Confirmation of whether he is still active at Core42 post-2023 merger, or has moved to a new organisation — his current employer determines whether this contact is warm or stale.

Sherif Tawfik

Chief Business Officer, Core42 (G42) — appointed March 2026

■ UAE (Abu Dhabi area)

No contact details found

CAREER HISTORY

- Chief Partnership Officer, G42 & Microsoft Global Alliance (Microsoft, ~2023–2026)
- Senior executive roles at Microsoft across MEA and Europe (25+ years total)
- Co-Founder & CEO, Fusion Minds AI (concurrent venture)

PROFILE

Sherif Tawfik is a 25-year Microsoft veteran who most recently led the G42 & Microsoft Global Alliance as Chief Partnership Officer — one of the largest sovereign AI and cloud partnerships globally, spanning Gulf government and enterprise deployments. In March 2026 he joined Core42 (G42's AI compute and cloud subsidiary) as Chief Business Officer, owning all global revenue functions including sales, BD, partnerships, and managed services. He also co-founded Fusion Minds AI, focused on responsible AI adoption and generative AI for sustainability. His profile is commercial and partnership-oriented; no signal on formal verification, supply chain tech, or agentic/Lean engineering.

VERIFICATION

Identity: **UNCONFIRMED**

Severe name collision risk. 'Sherif Tawfik' returns 70+ LinkedIn profiles (<https://linkedin.com/pub/dir/Sherif/Tawfik>) spanning entirely different industries and geographies. Distinct high-profile individuals include: (1) Sherif Tawfik at Core42 (Chief Business Officer, ex-25-year Microsoft execu...

GAPS & NEXT STEPS

- No GitHub profile found — no technical/engineering signal
- Fusion Minds AI: scope, funding, and current activity unclear
- Exact Microsoft roles held prior to G42 Alliance role not enumerated in public sources
- No evidence of involvement in AI governance policy (standards bodies, regulation) vs. commercial 'responsible AI' framing

Next step: LinkedIn full work history to confirm Microsoft role sequence and whether any policy/governance advisory roles (e.g., NIST, ISO, government AI councils) appear alongside the commercial positions